

Across Borders: The Trial Run

跨越边界：第一次试行

Theme: 旅行、交通与文化交流 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The trial run began in **April** and ran, with interruptions, until **December**. **Across February** and **June**, the team was **simply** too small; in **July** and **September** the **enrolment** in the **preparatory** course was enough, and in **October** and **November** it was **necessary** to postpone the demonstration. “**Maybe** in **May**,” the local minister said. “**Perhaps** next year.” **Nevertheless**, the work went on **alongside** the **cycling** club and the roadside **BBQ**, which was more popular than any of their workshops.

The case was a **geographic** one: a **faulty road**, a **damp** crossing, and a **hint** of corruption in the **luggage service**. “I can **predict** a delay,” Aisha said, “but I cannot **prescribe** a remedy without the local people.” A **Marxist essay**, a **poem** about a **spaceship**, and a **geometric** diagram of the intersection were all submitted as evidence, and all of them were criticized in the same week.

The **instant** the trial began, a **quarrelsome** driver was arrested for trafficking a spare tyre; the **contextual** part of the story was that his brother had lost the family job the year before. “We must **pursue** the system, not the man,” the team wrote, “and we must **retell** the case without the fear.”

The **indispensable** part was the **spontaneity** of the queue: people **simply** stepped forward when the timetable failed. “It is not **exploration**,” Maya said, “it is improvisation.” They wrote it down, and the **essay** that came out of it was better than the report.

What the team could not **demonstrate** was the one thing the council wanted: that a small change would survive a large system. “**Maybe** it will, **perhaps** it will not,” Lin wrote. “We can only see it through.” That sentence went into the report, **across** the whole width of the page, in their own hand. The local minister had said the team could expect nothing, and the team, **despite** everything, still had to allow for the service to fail. A car, a door, an area, a street, and a road: the small words of the report did most of the work. “If a problem arises far from the depot, we will run through it together,” Aisha said, “and that is a job nobody else wants.”

中文翻译

试行从四月开始，时断时续地持续到十二月。二月到六月期间，团队实在太小；七月和九月，预备课程的报名人数足够了；而十月和十一月，不得不把演示推迟。“也许五月吧，”地方部长说，“也许明年。”然而，工作仍在继续，与骑行俱乐部和路边烧烤同时进行，后者比他们的任何一场工作坊都受欢迎。

这个案子是地理性的：一条有缺陷的道路、一处潮湿的道口，以及行李服务中一丝腐败的气味。“我可以预测延误，”艾莎说，“但没有当地人，我开不出药方。”一篇马克思主义的随笔、一首关于宇宙飞船的诗，以及一张交叉路口的几何图，都被作为证据提交，而它们都在同一周受到了批评。

试行开始的那一刻，一位爱吵架的司机因贩卖一只备用轮胎而被捕；这个故事的情境部分是：他的哥哥前一年失去了家里的工作。“我们必须追查系统，而不是这个人，”团队写道，“而且我们必须不带恐惧地重述这个案子。”

不可缺少的部分是那条队伍的自发性：时刻表一失效，人们就自己上前。“这不是探索，”曼雅说，“这是即兴。”他们把它写了下来，而由此产生的那篇随笔比报告更好。

团队无法证明的，恰恰是委员会想要的那一件事：一个小的改变能否在一个大系统里存活下来。“也许会，也许不会，”林伟写道，“我们只能一路看下去。”这句话被写进了报告，横跨整页的宽度，用的是他们自己的笔迹。地方上的部长说过，这个团队什么也别指望；而这个团队，尽管经历了这一切，仍然必须为服务失败留出余地。一辆车、一扇门、一片区域、一条街、一条路：报告里这些小词承担了大部分工作。“如果问题出现在离车站很远的地方，我们就一起把它跑一遍，”艾莎说，“而这是一份没人愿意做的工作。”

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
may meɪ POS: n	n. 五月; aux. 能, 可以, 愿意 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the month following April and preceding June
perhaps pə'hæps POS: adv	adv. 也许, 大概 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r by chance
across ə'krɒs POS: prep	prep. 越过, 穿过, 与...相交, 在...的对面; adv. 交叉, 到另一边, 在对面, 成十字 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. to the opposite side; r. transversely
maybe 'meɪbi: POS: adv	adv. 也许, 大概; n. 可能性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r by chance
necessary 'nesɪsəri POS: a	a. 必要的; 必然的; 必需的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. absolutely essential; s. unavoidably determined by prior circumstances
simply 'sɪmplɪ POS: adv	adv. 简单地, 只是, 简直, 简朴地, 坦白地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. absolutely; altogether; really
April 'eɪprəl POS: n	n. 四月 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the month following March and preceding May
despite dɪ'spaɪt POS: n	n. 轻视, 憎恨; prep. 虽然, 尽管 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. contemptuous disregard
June dʒu:n POS: n	n. 六月 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the month following May and preceding July
July dʒu:'laɪ POS: n	n. 七月 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the month following June and preceding August
October ɒk'təʊbə POS: n	n. 十月 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the month following September and preceding November
September sep'tembə POS: n	n. 九月 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the month following August and preceding October
arise ə'raɪz POS: v	vi. 站立, 出现, 起来 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. originate or come into being; v. rise to one's feet; v. result or issue
November nəʊ'vembə POS: n	n. 十一月 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the month following October and preceding December
December dɪ'sembə POS: n	n. 十二月 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the last (12th) month of the year
February 'februəri POS: n	n. 二月 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the month following January and preceding March
nevertheless ,neveðə'les POS: adv	adv. 然而, 虽然如此; conj. 然而 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r despite anything to the contrary (usually following a concession)
demonstrate 'demənstreɪt POS: vt	vt. 示范, 证明; vi. 示威 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. march in protest; take part in a demonstration
predict prɪ'dɪkt POS: v	v. 预知, 预言, 预报 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make a prediction about; tell in advance
pursue pə'sju: POS: vt	vt. 追赶, 追踪, 追随, 追求, 实行, 继续, 从事; vi. 追赶, 继续 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. follow in or as if in pursuit; v. carry further or advance
arrest ə'rest POS: n	n. 逮捕, 监禁; vt. 拘捕, 抑制, 吸引, 阻止 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of inactivity following an interruption
poem 'pəʊɪm POS: n	n. 诗, 诗般美的事物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a composition written in metrical feet forming rhythmical lines
essay 'eseɪ. e'sei POS: n	n. 随笔, 短文, 评论, 企图; vt. 试图 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an analytic or interpretive literary composition; n. a tentative attempt
criticize 'krɪtɪsaɪz POS: v	v. 批评, 吹毛求疵, 非难 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. act as a critic
alongside ə'lɒŋ'saɪd POS: adv	adv. 在旁边, 靠拢着; prep. 在...旁边, 与...在一起 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r side by side

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
hint hint POS: n	n. 暗示, 提示; v. 暗示, 示意 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an indirect suggestion; n. a slight indication; v. drop a hint; intimate by a hint
damp dæmp POS: n	n. 潮湿, 湿气; a. 潮湿的; vt. 使潮湿, 使阻尼, 抑止; vi. 变潮湿, 衰减 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a slight wetness; v. restrain or discourage; s. slightly wet
exploration ˌeksplə'reɪʃən POS: n	n. 探险, 踏勘, 探测; [医] 探索 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. to travel for the purpose of discovery; n. a careful systematic search; n. a systematic consideration
instant 'ɪnstənt POS: n	n. 立即, 瞬间; a. 紧急的, 立即的, 即时的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. in or of the present month
prescribe prɪ'skraɪb POS: v	v. 规定, 指定, 嘱咐, 开处方 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v issue commands or orders for
Marxist 'mɑ:ksɪst POS: a	a. 马克思主义的; n. 马克思主义者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an advocate of Marxism; a. following the ideas of Marx and Engels
geographic ˌdʒiə'græfɪk POS: a	a. 地理(学)的, 地区(性)的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to the science of geography; a. determined by geography
luggage 'lʌɡɪdʒ POS: n	n. 行李, 皮箱 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n cases used to carry belongings when traveling
cycling 'saɪklɪŋ POS: n	n. 骑脚踏车兜风, 骑脚踏车消遣; [机] 循环操作 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the sport of traveling on a bicycle or motorcycle
geometric ˌdʒiəu'metɪk POS: a	a. 几何学的, 几何学上的, 几何学图形的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. characterized by simple geometric forms in design and decoration; a. of or relating to or determined by geo...
faulty 'fɔ:ltɪ POS: a	a. 有过失的, 有缺点的, 不完美的, 应受责备的; [经] 缺点多的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. characterized by errors; not agreeing with a model or not following established rules; the wrong side of t...
indispensable ˌɪndɪ'spensəbl POS: n	n. 不可缺少之物; a. 不可缺少的, 责无旁贷的, 绝对必要的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. not to be dispensed with; essential; s. unavoidable
preparatory prɪ'pæreɪtəri POS: a	a. 预备性的, 准备性的; n. 预科 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. preceding and preparing for something
enrolment ɪn'rɔ:lmənt POS: n	n. 登记, 注册, 入伍, 入学, 入会, 注册人数, 入学人数 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the act of enrolling
contextual kɒn'tekstʃuəl POS: a	a. 上下文的, 前后关系的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to or determined by or in context
spaceship 'speɪʃɪp POS: n	n. 宇宙飞船 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a spacecraft designed to carry a crew into interstellar space (especially in science fiction)
spontaneity ˌspɒntə'ni:ti POS: n	n. 自然发生, 自生, 自发 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of being spontaneous and coming from natural feelings without constraint
retell rɪ'tel POS: vt	vt. 再讲, 重复, 重说 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v render verbally, "recite a poem"; v make into fiction; v to say, state, or perform again
quarrelsome 'kwɒrəlsəm POS: a	a. 喜欢吵架的, 好争论的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. given to quarreling
BBQ phonetic unavailable POS: abbr	abbr. 野外烧烤 (barbecue); 烧烤炉 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: No reliable source example available.